

Secondary Examination, 2017

English

Time: $2\frac{1}{2}$ Hours

Maximum Marks: 80

GENERAL INSTRUCTIONS TO THE EXAMINEES:

1. Attempt all questions.
 2. The first fifteen minutes is cool –off time.
 3. Use the cool –off time to read the questions and plan the answers.
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Question 1-5 Read the following passage and answer the question given that follow:

A professor once told me my characters were too much like him, an educated and middle- class man. My characters drove cars. They were not starving. Therefore, they were not authentically African.

When I learned, some years ago that writers were expected to have had really unhappy childhood to be successful, I began to think about how I could invent horrible things my parents had done to me. But the truth is that I had a very happy childhood, full of laughter and love, in a very close- knit family.

Questions:

1. Why did the Professor think that Adichie's characters were not authentically African? (1)
2. What kind of a person was the Professor? (1)
3. Adichie thought of inventing horrible things her parents had done to her. Why? (1)
4. What kind of a childhood did Adichie have? (1)
5. Find out from the passage an expression that means 'closely connected'. (2)

Solutions:

1. Professor thought that Adichie's characters were not authentically African because they were not starving and couldn't drive cars.
2. The Professor was an educated middle - class man.
3. Adichie's conviction was that writers were expected to have had unhappy childhood to be successful.
4. Adichie had very happy childhood, full of laughter and love.
5. Close- Knit.

Question 6-9 Read the lines from the poem ‘The School Boy’ and answer the question given that follow:

I love to rise in a summer morn,
When the birds sing on every tree;
The distant huntsman winds his horn,
And the skylark sings with me:
O what sweet company!

But to go to school in a summer morn, -
O it drives all joy away!
Under a cruel eye outworn,
The little ones spend the day
In sighing and dismay.

Questions:

6. What are the sounds that welcome the boy in a summer morning (1)
7. What drives ‘all joy away’ from the boy’s mind? (1)
8. Whose cruel eyes keep the children under control? (1)
9. How do the children spend their day at the school? (1)

Solutions:

6. The song of birds, the distant huntsman winds his horn and the song of the skylark, these are the sounds that welcome the boy in a summer morning.
7. To go to school in a summer morn / morning drives all joy away from the boy’s mind.
8. The cruel eyes of the teacher keep the children under control.
9. The Children spent the day in sighing and dismay.

Question 10: Read the lines from ‘Mother to son’ by Lanston Hughes and answer the question given that follow:

Well, son, I’ll tell you:
Life for me ain’t been no crystal stair.
It’s had tacks in it,
And splinters,
And boards torn up,
And places with no carpet on the floor—
Bare.
But all the time
I’ve been a-climbin’ on,
And reachin’ landin’s,
And turnin’ corners,
And sometimes goin’ in the dark

Where there ain't been no light.
So boy, don't you turn back.

Attempt a brief appreciation of the poem, focusing on the theme, imagery and the language in the poem.

Solution 10:

Langston Hughes's Poem "Mother to Son" is a very attractive poem written as a first person narrative in simple language and crystal clear imageries. The words are coming from the heart of a mother who had faced so many ups and downs in her life. She tided over all the obstacles and challenges for the sake of her only son. That is why the mother tells her son very simply and directly what all difficulties she had crossed in her way. Using some metaphors like 'Splinters, Carpets and boards' she drove a very lucid imagery in the eyes of her son. She admits that all the time in her life she has been climbing on and sometimes groping in the darks where there was not even a single gleam of light. The poet concludes the poem with an advice given to son by his mother. The poem is written in a very simple language. The poet has used imageries after imagery to depict whatever things the mother wanted to convey to her son.

Question 11 – 14: Read the following story and answer the question given that follow:

There was once a big flood in the river. The water came down from the mountain and the hills, the river came up and up, and a lot of houses on the low land were soon under the water.

The Red Cross sent some me, and they brought food and dry clothes and took some people to higher ground on boats.

An old man lived in a small house near the river. He was poor and there were no houses near his. There was a heavy rain one night and in the morning, the old man looked out of the window and saw the flood. The water was nearly up to his bedroom window.

The water came up and up. Then the flood got worse and the old man went up on to the roof. "What am I going to do?" he said. "The water is very deep and I can't swim".

But after three hours, the old man saw a boat. It slowly came near, and the old man saw two young men in it. "We've come from the Red Cross...." one of the young men said.

"I'm sorry", the old man answered, "but I've just given you some money this month, and I haven't got much. I'm a poor man".

Questions:

11. Where did the water come from? (1)
12. When did the old man see the flood? (1)
13. Why did the old man go up to his roof? (1)
14. Why did the Red Cross men go there? (1)

Solutions:

11. The water came from the mountain and hill.
12. When the old man looked around in morning after a heavy rain he saw the flood.
13. The water was nearly up to his bedroom window, and it continued coming up and up. Then the old man went up to his roof.
14. The Red Cross men went up to the old man to save his life.

Question 15 – 20: The following are the online advertisement of some Tour Operators. Study the details and answer the questions that follows:

Tourient Travels	Miles of Smiles	My Happy Journey
You can book flights, hotels, car rentals, activity plans and full holiday packages.	Our tittle is derived from ensuring that our customers are happy about the services provided to them.	My happy Journey was established with the sole aim of offering the mist exclusive and memorable experience to travelers and vacationers.
Enjoy the best of tourism with Tourient – a name tourism oriented like no other.	We have customized and unique packages for international tors such as to Thailand, Europe, East Asia, Australia and New Zealand. We regularly review our management procedure and evaluate service delivery.	Since its inception in 2007, our company has surpasses many milestones. We are an ISO certified company with comfortable travel options, wonderful restaurants and shopping places which our clients would love to know to make their travel experience.

Questions:

15. Which company was established in 2007? (1)
16. Which tour operator says it wants to ensure customer satisfaction? (1)
17. Which company should we opt for, if we want to make an international trip? (1)
18. Which company is ISO certified (1)
19. Which tour operator offers full holiday package? (1)
20. Name the company that conducts reviews of services delivered. (1)

Solutions:

15. My Happy Journey.
16. Miles of smiles

17. We must opt for Miles of Smiles, if we want to make an international trips.
18. My Happy Journey.
19. Tourient Travels.
20. Mile of Smiles is the company that conducts reviews of services delivered.

21. Answer any one of the following in about 120 words:

(7)

(A) “I could hardly believe my ears. I spoke in a trembling rush. ‘Oh! Thank you sir!’ Suddenly I felt great”. These words of happiness show how much the scholarship jacket means to Martha. Briefly **narrate** her story in your own words. You may use the hints given.

(**Hints:** wishes to get the scholarship jacket – works hard – overhears the conversation between Boone and Schmidt – principal asks her to pay for the scholarship jacket – grand pa refuses – finally awarded)

OR

“As we sat in silence, I could not but reflect that it was the best investment I had made in my life. It had paid me no dividends in worldly goods, but had turned out to be immensely profitable.” Why does the narrator say no? Narrate in your words the events that led to this remark.

(**Hints:** The narrator meets a man on his way back from New York – he recounts an old incident- goes to attend one who had attempted suicide – young man saved – he later becomes a solicitor and a social activist – the meeting prompts the narrator to reflect on the best investment he had made)

Solution 21:

Format for Narrative:

- Proper beginning and end.
- Time and place of action.
- Organisation of ideas.
- Creativity and imagination

OR

22. ‘Now, things changed when I discovered African books’. Prepare a **write up** on how the reading of African books influenced Adichie’s writing. (5)

Solution 22:

Format for Write-up

- A suitable Title
- Begins with sticking idea
- Ideas are presented using Specific and clear language.
- Ideas are organized well.
- Used variety of sentences
- Appropriate conclusion.

23. Satyajit ray meets the manager of Bhart Circus to provide him with the service of a tiger for the shooting of his film. Write the **likely conversation** between Ray and the manager? (5)

Solution 23:

Points to avoid in writing conversation:

1. Avoid fillers
2. Cut Unnecessary Dialogue Tags
3. Avoid fancy Dialogue tags
4. Change the Placement of Dialogue Tags
5. Include Disagreement or Conflicts.
6. Involve Character's Desires, Goals, and Fears
7. Include Subtle Gestures and Subtext
8. Add context for atmosphere and Tone

Format of Conversation:

1. Using Right Punctuation
2. Insert Quotation Marks
3. Use Exclamation and Question Marks
4. Use Ellipses and Dashes Correctly
5. Break a long Dialogue into Short paragraphs.

24. The doctor in the story 'The Snake and the Mirror' writes about his strange experience in his diary. Prepare the likely diary entry. (5)

Solution 24:

Format to write Diary entry:

- Conveys the feelings and emotions of the writer. It is a first person narrative.
- Highlights the important event/s happened on a particular day.
- Use expression and broken sentences

- Never records the routine activities.

25. Poor Vanka is in a miserable condition. Imagine that as a resident of the locality, you came to know about Vanka's pitiable life at the shoemaker's house. Write a **letter** to a police official describing Vanka's hardships and also the cruelty of his master, and requesting him to save the child. (5)

Solution 25:

LETTER

Uses proper format i.e. place, Date, Salutation

CONTENT:

- Good beginning
- Idea conveyed
- Proper conclusion
- Proper Complementary Close

26. The English Club of your schools is organizing a debate on 'Social Media: A Boon or Bane'. You are the secretary of the club. Draft a **notice** inviting the students and teachers to the programme. (5)

Solution 26.

Format to write notice:

- Uses appropriate format and layout of a notice
- Uses proper salutation.
- Mentions the date, time and venue of the programme
- Uses clear and brief language
- Includes the details of the programme
- Specifies the agency /Authority which issues the notice

27. Complete the following conversation between Martha and a News reporter. (5)

Reporter : You are Martha, _____ (a) _____?

Martha : Yes, I am.

Reporter : _____ (b) _____?

Martha : I'm in class eight.

Reporter : You won the Scholarship Jacket, _____ (c) _____ ?

Martha : Yes, I did.

Reporter : _____ (d) _____ ?

Martha : No, I didn't pay anything.

Reporter : Indeed you deserve it. _____ (e) _____ ?

Martha : Thank You sir.

Solution 27:

- a) aren't you?
- b) Which class do you belong ?
- c) didn't you?
- d) Did you pay for it?
- e) how awful!

28. There are a few errors in the passage given below. They are underlined. Edit the passage making corrections. (4)

Another lovely thought struck me. I would got (a) married to a woman doctor who have (b). Plenty of money and a good medical practice. She had to be fat; for a valid reason. If I made some mistake silly (c) and needed to run away, she should not be able to ran after (d) me.

Solution 28:

- a) would get
- b) had
- c) silly mistake
- d) run after

29. Report the following dialogue. (2)

Son : Where did you get it, father?

Father : I picked it up.

You may begin in this manner:

The son asked his father.....

The father

Solution 29:

- (a) The Son asked his father where had he got it from.
- (b) The father replied that he had picked it up.

30. Supply the missing words in the passage given below: (4)

Needless to say, in our country it/(a) not at all easy to find trained animals,/(b) some films have been made/(c) Bombay and N=Madras that involved working/ (d) elephants, horses and tigers.

(in, is, that, although, with)

Solution 30:

- a) is
- b) although
- c) in
- d) with

31. Complete the following passage choosing appropriate phrasal verbs from the box given below: (4)

Amal has never been able to _____ (a) _____ early from bed. Though his mother would set the alarm clock, Amal simply turned it off and went back to sleep. Every morning, he would _____ (b) _____ late to school. So, he _____ (c) _____ the class late every day. Amal knew well that his class teacher would not _____ (d) _____ with the situation.

Put up with	Get up	Give up	Put out	Get into
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Solution 31:

- a) get up
- b) set out
- c) got into
- d) put up with

32. Write a short profile of Rabindranath Tagore using the details given below: (5)

Born : 1861

Famous as : poet, short story writer, musician, educationist and philosopher

Achievement : The first non- European to win the Nobel Prize for literature

Important works : 'Gitanjali', 'The Golden Boat', 'Cabuliwalah', 'The Post Office', 'The Broken Nest' etc

Died : 1941

Solution 32:

Format to write Profile:

- Give a title

- Effective introduction and ending.
- Well Organised Details.
- Use of Appropriate descriptive vocabulary.
- Hints developed using supporting details.
- Use of proper linkers for connecting the ideas
- Use of appropriate language.